

Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts

Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
May 22, 2014
7:00 p.m.

Minutes

The Medford School Committee of the Whole was called to order at 7:08 p.m. by Vice Chairperson John Falco Jr. in the Library of Medford High School.

Members present: Anne Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, John Falco Jr., George Scarpelli, Robert Skerry Jr., and Paulette Van der Kloot. (6 present 1 absent)

Administrators present: Superintendent Roy Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Principals: Kevin Andrews, Diane Guarino, Kirk Johnson, Kathy Kay, Paul D'Alleva, Jake Edwards and Headmaster John Perella. Assistant Principals: Doreen Andrews, Suzanne Galusi and Nancy Sherman Hudson.

All rose to salute the flag.

Vice Chairperson John Falco stated that the purpose of the meeting was to review the school council reports. He then called upon the Superintendent to an overview.

The Superintendent noted that each member had received a notebook containing each school council report. He asked that all finance items be referred to our budget hearings in June.

Brooks School/ Kevin Andrews - Key Points:

- Need to narrow the achievement gap on MCAS
- Need to do more preliminary assessments pre MCAS to target instruction
- Would like additional lap top computers (8)
- Current Linux classroom computers not very effective
- PARCC experience was good
- Several teacher retirements
- Journeys program working well.
- Building cleanliness is ok

Columbus School/Kathy Kay - Key Points

- Need a new math program – currently piloting “Envision”
- Keep math support – would like it full year
- Linux classroom computers old generation
- Needs a full time ruse
- Developed a behavior matrix for TLP program – working well
- Journeys program is a good addition
- Put LED projectors in ceiling in K classrooms
- Building cleanliness ok
- PARCC went ok

McGlynn Elementary/Diane Guarino – Key Points

- Keep math support and expand to full year
- Full time Assistant Principal is a good addition
- More ELL instruction needed
- Journeys working well
- Older computers less used
- Would like a new math program
- Building cleanliness could be better
- Suggest possibility of a late bus to promote extra help
- PARCC went well

Roberts School/Kirk Johnson – Key Points

- Journeys a good addition
- Would like a new math program
- The addition of a full time adjustment counselor has been very good to deal with social/emotional issues
- More ELL help is needed
- Math support was good – would like it all year
- Need replacement chairs (200)
- PARCC went well – Roberts did paper and pencil version
- Possible use of Heineman DVDs for professional development
- Building cleanliness has been good

Andrews Middle School/Paul D’Alleva – Key Points

- All an additional therapeutic learning teacher to handle social/emotional need of Andrews students in that program
- More funding for extra curricular programs is recommended
- Technology is good – need to better connect WiFi and Mimeo technology
- PARCC went well
- Math placement test now using multiple data points to determine placement
- Building cleanliness is ok

McGlynn Middle/Jake Edwards – Key Points

- Population changes are significant/66 cultures represented in the school
- Social and emotional challenges are growing
- Need additional math help for ELL students
- Social media challenges
- Library computers need upgrade
- PARCC went well
- Building cleanliness is ok by could use more

Medford High/Vocational/John Perella – Key Points

- Working on merger of certain high school/vocational academic courses
- Modifying schedules 6 day – 5 day
- Adding 2 foreign language teachers to provide 6.6 schedule
- Community Conservation Partnership (see attached)
- MHS – Tufts Education Partnership expanding (see attached)
- MHS – Harvard School Culture Project (see attached)
- Busy year with construction but it was handled by faculty, staff and administration
- A high school registration position would be helpful
- PARCC went ok

School committee wants an end of year report on all the major accomplishments – Public Relations is very important.

On the motion of Mr. Scarpelli, seconded by Ms. Cugno the reports were accepted and financial items referred to the budget process. (6-0-1)

On the motion of Ms. Cugno seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the meeting was adjourned at 10:16 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,

John Falco
Vice Chairperson